



The filter feeders

Some of the largest whales have no teeth. Instead they filter their food from the sea through fringed brushes called baleen plates that hang down inside their mouths.

Big appetite, small food

Despite their size, the whales that filter food eat enormous quantities of tiny, shrimplike creatures called krill. Each is no longer than your finger.

A humpback whale's baleen is about 40 in (100 cm) in length.

Humpback whales fish in groups of up to 25.

In the groove

Some filter feeders, such as these humpbacks, have throat grooves. These allow their mouths and throats to expand to take in tons of water.

The whales take huge gulps of seawater and food, then sieve out the food.

